

According to Noah, “our lifestyle didn’t change that much, but we had a purpose for the money we were saving . . . getting us to FI.” The specific strategies and tactics that can lead to such dramatic changes will be covered as you learn to spend less, earn more, and invest better later in this book.

Maybe the most dramatic awakening among the stories Brad and Jonathan collected was that of Scott Rieckens, a new father living a seemingly dream life in beautiful Coronado Beach, near San Diego. According to Scott, “I couldn’t shake a nagging feeling that . . . the more success that we were finding, the harder we were working, the more would come up and the busier we would get . . . I would wake up in the morning and kiss my wife and kid, and I would head out the door to pay for this lifestyle. But I was rarely enjoying it myself.”

He knew he wanted FI but had no idea how to achieve it. He was trapped in the belief that he would need some million-dollar business idea or invention. Isn’t that how people get rich? He started listening to one entrepreneurial podcast after another, reinforcing this idea. Until one specific podcast episode led to his awakening. He recalled the day—February 13, 2017. On an episode of *The Tim Ferriss Show* titled “Living Beautifully on \$25-27k Per Year,” Ferriss